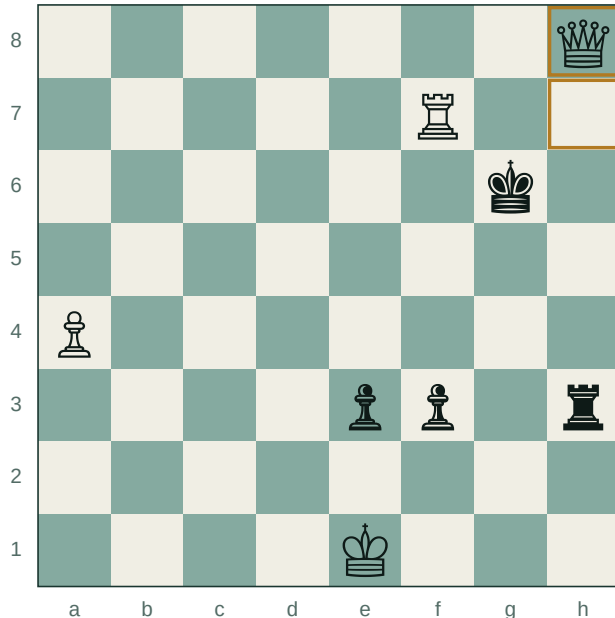


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 50

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 50.h8=Q. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

50...f2+ 51. Ke2 Rxf2 52. Rf3 Rh1

50...f2+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **51.Ke2**.

51...Rxf2 The rook captures the queen on h8. Recorded reply: **52.Rf3**.

52...Rh1 The rook moves from h8 to h1.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -8 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: queen on h8 and rook on f7. Check for tactical protection.